

Day 1 — Ayurveda’s Place in IKS

Module: Ayurveda (Senior) · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

Students locate Ayurveda within the IKS map and name the 8 branches and 3 foundational texts.

Materials

- Whiteboard
- Reference card with the 8 branches

Flow

Warm-up (5 min)

Provocation: “*In what way is Ayurveda ‘science’? In what way is it not?*”

Take 3 student answers.

Core (25 min)

1. **Ayurveda’s place.** Ayurveda is an **Upaveda** — a “subordinate Veda.” Specifically, it’s traditionally an Upaveda of the **Atharva Veda** (which contained early medical material).
2. **The 8 branches (aṣṭāṅga Ayurveda):**

#	Sanskrit	Domain
1	Kāya-cikitsā	Internal medicine
2	Bāla-cikitsā	Pediatrics
3	Graha-cikitsā	“Psychiatry” / affliction medicine
4	Ūrdhvāṅga-cikitsā	ENT, ophthalmology
5	Śalya-tantra	Surgery
6	Daṁṣṭra-cikitsā	Toxicology
7	Jarā-cikitsā	Geriatrics, rejuvenation
8	Vṛ̥ṣa-cikitsā	Reproductive medicine

Note: this is a *comprehensive* medical framework, not just herbalism.

3. **The bṛhatrayī (“great three”) foundational texts:**
 - **Caraka Saṃhitā** (~2nd c. BCE) — internal medicine focus. Attributed to Caraka; redacted by Dṛḍhabala.
 - **Suśruta Saṃhitā** (~6th c. BCE or later) — surgery focus. Suśruta is the source of the cataract-surgery and rhinoplasty procedures Module 1 covered.

- **Aṣṭāṅga Hṛdaya** (~7th c. CE) — synthesis by Vāgbhaṭa; standard classical textbook.
- 4. **The honest scope:** Ayurveda was (and is) a comprehensive medical system covering internal medicine, surgery, pediatrics, psychiatry, ENT, toxicology. It is NOT just “herbs.”

Discussion (10 min)

- Which branch surprised you most?
- Where does Ayurveda overlap with modern medicine cleanly?

Wrap-up (5 min)

- Preview Day 2: “*Tomorrow — we read Caraka Saṃhitā Sūtra-sthāna ch. 1 in IAST.*”

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Read Wujastyk (2003) intro chapter.
- **Tier down:** Memorise the 3 foundational texts + 4 of the 8 branches.

Teacher notes

- Many students think Ayurveda = herbal teas. The 8-branches list is a corrective.
- The Suśruta-surgery point ties to Module 1; reinforces continuity.

Citation(s) used

- Wujastyk (2003), introduction.
- Caraka Saṃhitā Sūtra-sthāna ch. 1 — Sharma (1981).